McDonald's Sales

Analysis Report

Insights from the Excel Dashboard

Tools: Excel | PivotTables | Slicers | Charts

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Dashboard Overview

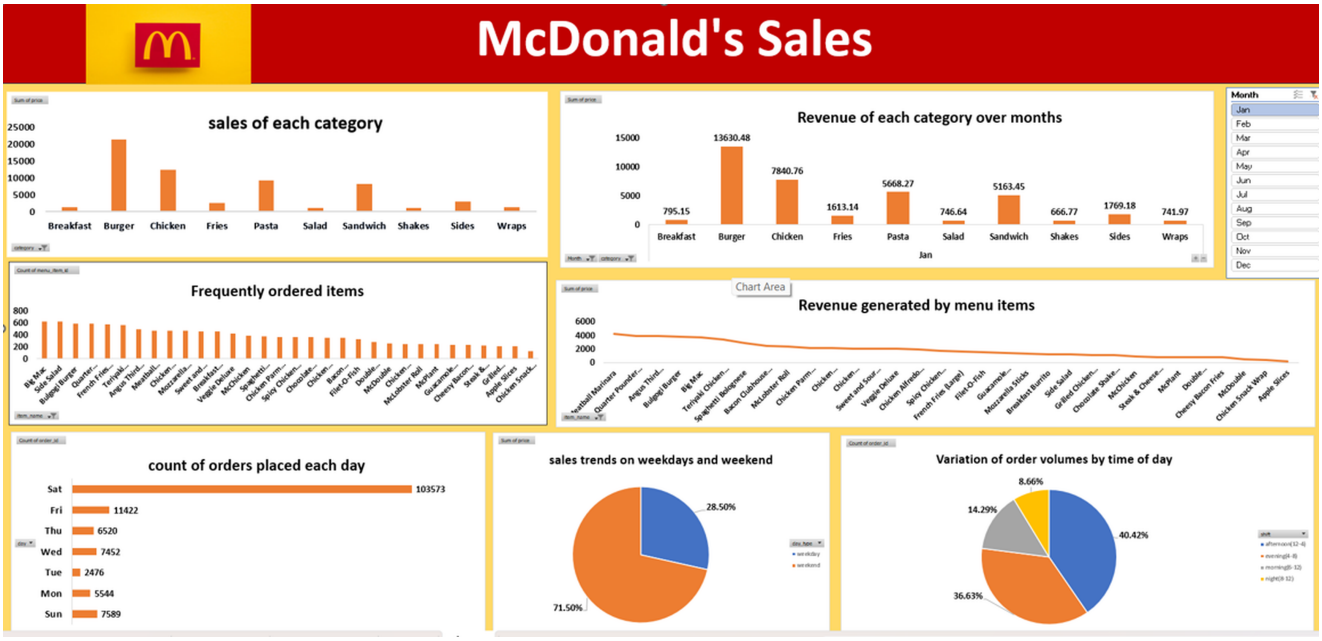


Figure 1: McDonald's Sales dashboard (Excel)

What the dashboard covers

- **Category view:** sales and monthly revenue for 10 categories (Breakfast, Burger, Chicken, Fries, Pasta, Salad, Sandwich, Shakes, Sides, Wraps).
- **Menu-item view:** most frequently ordered items and revenue generated by each item.
- **Time view:** orders by day of week, weekday vs weekend sales, and order volume by time of day.
- **Interactivity:** a month slicer filters the category revenue chart (January is selected in this view).

Headline takeaways

- **Burgers lead every category** and generate roughly 35% of January revenue on their own.
- **Four categories (Burger, Chicken, Pasta, Sandwich) deliver about 84%** of January category revenue.
- **Demand is concentrated in time:** weekends account for about 71.5% of sales and afternoon + evening for about 77% of orders.
- **Item popularity is spread out:** no single item dominates, and order frequency declines gradually down the menu.

1. Category Performance



Figure 2: Sales of each category and revenue by category (January)

Key insights

- **Burger is the clear #1 category,** with total sales above 20,000 and January revenue of **13,630.48**, well ahead of any other category.
- **Chicken is the strong #2** (January revenue 7,840.76), followed by **Pasta (5,668.27)** and **Sandwich (5,163.45)**.
- **Long tail of low performers:** Sides (1,769.18), Fries (1,613.14), Breakfast (795.15), Salad (746.64), Wraps (741.97) and Shakes (666.77) each contribute under 5% of January revenue.
- **The category ranking is consistent** between the all-period sales chart and the January view, which suggests stable category preferences across the period.
- **Sides, Fries and Shakes are add-on products.** Their low revenue may reflect low price points rather than low demand, so attach rate per order is worth checking.

Recommendations

- Protect and promote the Burger and Chicken lines, as they carry the revenue base.
- Bundle Sides, Fries and Shakes with burger and chicken meals to lift basket value.
- Review Breakfast, Salad and Wraps for repositioning, promotion or menu simplification.

2. Menu Item Performance



Figure 3: Frequently ordered items and revenue generated by menu items

Key insights

- **Order frequency is flat at the top.** The most-ordered items (Big Mac, Side Salad, Bulgogi Burger and similar) each have roughly 600+ orders, and there is no single runaway best seller.
- **Gradual decline across the menu:** order counts fall smoothly from about 650 to around 150 for the least-ordered items (for example Apple Slices), a roughly 4x gap between top and bottom.
- **Revenue follows a smooth downward curve,** from about 4,300 for the top item (Meatball Marinara) toward zero for low-priced items.
- **Popularity is not the same as revenue.** The most-ordered item is not the top revenue item. Meatball Marinara leads revenue, which points to a higher price point driving its contribution.
- **Low-price items such as Apple Slices and Chicken Snack Wrap** sit at the bottom on both volume and revenue, making them candidates for review.

Recommendations

- Use high-frequency items as traffic drivers and pair them with high-revenue items as upsell suggestions.
- Review the bottom-tail items for removal, bundling or promotion to reduce menu complexity.
- Evaluate price and margin per item, not just order count, before deciding which items to push.

3. Order Timing Patterns

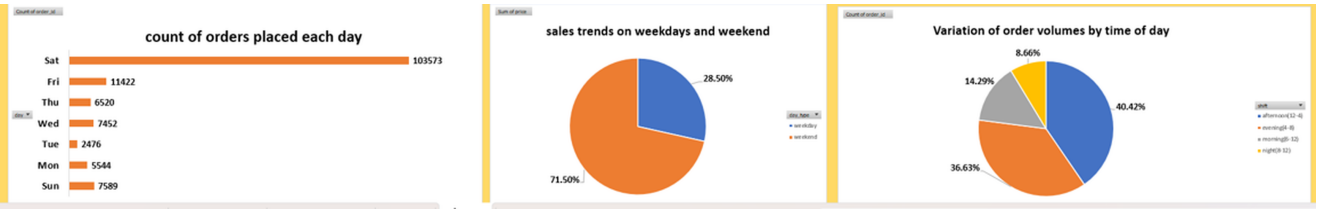


Figure 4: Orders by day, weekday vs weekend sales, and order volume by time of day

Key insights

- **Saturday dominates order volume with 103,573 orders.** The next highest day is Friday with 11,422, and Tuesday is the lowest with 2,476.
- **Weekend sales share is 71.5%** versus 28.5% on weekdays, which matches the Saturday-heavy order pattern.
- **Afternoon (12-4) is the peak shift at 40.42%** of orders, followed by evening (4-8) at 36.63%. Together they account for about **77%** of all orders.
- **Morning (14.29%) and night (8.66%)** are the weakest shifts, so there is potential for breakfast and late-night growth.
- **Weekday demand is weak and uneven,** with Tuesday and Monday trailing, so staffing and promotions can be tuned to the lull.

Data check worth doing

Saturday orders are about 9x the next-highest day, which is unusually extreme. Before presenting this as a business finding, verify how the day-of-week was derived (date parsing, a default or placeholder date, or duplicated records). If it holds up, it is a major scheduling and staffing insight.

Recommendations

- Staff and stock up for weekend and the 12-8 pm window.
- Run weekday offers (Monday to Tuesday) and morning combos to even out demand.

Overall Conclusion

Area	Finding	Action
Categories	Burger ~35% of Jan revenue; top 4 categories ~84%	Double down on Burger and Chicken; bundle sides
Menu items	Flat popularity at the top; revenue driven by price	Upsell high-revenue items; trim the tail
Day of week	Saturday 103,573 orders; weekends 71.5% of sales	Validate data; weekend staffing and weekday offers
Time of day	Afternoon + evening ~77% of orders	Peak-hour capacity; grow morning and night

Bottom line

Sales are concentrated in a few places: burgers and chicken for products, weekends for days, and afternoon and evening for hours. The biggest opportunities are growing weaker categories and time slots, using bundles to raise average order value, and confirming the Saturday spike so decisions rest on solid data.